The nation had a distinct view that the United States was purposefully obstructing global financial reform, particularly within the IMF.[37]

Illustrating China's frustration with the United States, the prominent and well-connected observer Wang Jisi stated that "even in the economic realm, the two sides still harbor substantial divergent interests and contrasting visions of the future global order they hope to see."[38] Meanwhile, "emerging powers like India, Brazil, Russia, and South Africa are increasingly challenging Western dominance and are working more closely with each other and with China in doing so."[39] Also manifest in the policy pronouncement of the former President Jiang Zemin (1993–2003) is the concept of "democratization of international relations," which has been at the front and center of China's stance toward global financial governance. The concept suggests that "international affairs should be decided by all states in the world peacefully through dialogue and negotiation," but more fundamentally, it means that "domestic politics should be left to a country's people and government to decide."[40] Moreover, the Chinese leadership has always been wary of fundamentally intrusive economic instruments used by external powers to influence the Chinese economy, society, and politics. Hence, China hopes to induce more pressure to change the Western domination in global economic governance by hanging together with the BRICS.

Increase China's Voice in the System

The second motivation for China to work with the BRICS is to use the new global financial forums effectively to increase its voice in the global system. The G20 process, which was converted in November 2008 from meetings of finance ministers and central bankers to summits with heads of state, has become the main forum for this purpose.[41] The BRICs finance ministers first convened for a conference in São Paulo, Brazil, in November 2008 in preparation for the first G20 summit in Washington, DC. Since the Cannes G20 Summit (November 2011), the leaders of the five countries have habitually met just prior to the G20 summits to coordinate their positions. "Group making" (*jí tuán huà*) has become a new approach that China uses to address the issues of global governance.[42] With the birth of this new forum, along with discussions at the United Nations where emerging powers tackle the dominance of institutional power of the advanced